THE NO-CODE FOUNDER SERIES · 2026 EDITION

30 Micro SaaS You Can Build Without Coding

Validated product ideas, the exact no-code stack for each one, and a four-week plan to get your first paying customer.

30 idea cards | Tool stacks included | Validation framework | Pricing guidance

A practical playbook for non-technical founders

30 Micro SaaS You Can Build Without Coding

A Practical 2026 Playbook for Non-Technical Founders

First edition, 2026.

About this book. Every idea in Part Two was drawn from published market research, founder revenue reports and community demand signals current as of mid-2026. Pricing ranges, build times and tool costs are indicative benchmarks, not quotes — software vendors change their plans frequently, so verify current pricing on each vendor's own site before you commit money.

A necessary disclaimer. This book is educational material, not financial, legal or investment advice. No revenue outcome is promised or implied. The published data is blunt about this: most micro SaaS products never reach $1,000 per month. The ideas here are starting points that still require your judgement, your effort and your willingness to talk to real customers.

How to use it. Read Part One once. Skim Part Two and mark three ideas. Then work through Part Three with one of them. Reading all thirty ideas without acting on one is the most common way to waste this book.

CONTENTS

What's inside

FRONT

PART ONE — FOUNDATIONS

PART TWO — THE 30 IDEAS

PART THREE — FROM IDEA TO PAYING CUSTOMER

APPENDICES

INTRODUCTION

Read this first

Five years ago, launching a software product meant raising money, hiring engineers and waiting six months before a single person could try it. That is no longer true. The bottleneck has moved — from *can I build this?* to *what should I build, and who will pay for it?*

This book exists to answer the second question. It assumes you cannot write code and have no intention of learning. It assumes you have limited time, a modest budget and no co-founder. And it assumes you would rather build one small, profitable, boring thing than chase a billion-dollar idea that never ships.

What you are holding

Three parts, each with a different job.

Part One gives you the vocabulary and the map. What a micro SaaS is, why the economics work for a solo founder, what the no-code stack actually looks like in 2026, and roughly what it costs to run. Read this once, properly. It is short.

Part Two is the reference section: thirty idea cards. Each one names a specific customer, a specific pain, a suggested price, a no-code stack that can deliver it, an honest build-time estimate and a note on where to find your first customers. These are structured so you can compare them quickly rather than read them cover to cover.

Part Three is the part that actually determines whether you make money. Validation, building, pricing, distribution, and the mistakes that reliably kill these businesses. If you only have one hour, spend it here.

> **THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT IDEA IN THIS BOOK**
>
> Your idea is not your advantage. Every idea in Part Two is public, and other people are reading the same lists. Your advantage is the customer you understand better than anyone else, and your willingness to talk to ten of them before you build anything. Ideas are a starting line, not a moat.

Who this is for

- **The non-technical professional** with deep knowledge of one industry — logistics, healthcare, real estate, education — who keeps noticing the same broken workflow.
- **The freelancer or consultant** who wants recurring revenue that does not require selling hours forever.
- **The employee with a side project itch** who has evenings and weekends, not a runway.
- **The operator or analyst** who has already built internal automations and suspects other companies

would pay for the same thing.

What this book will not do

It will not make you rich in ninety days. It will not hand you a validated business. And it will not pretend the odds are better than they are — Chapter 2 gives you the real distribution of outcomes, including the uncomfortable parts.

What it will do is remove the two things that stop most non-technical founders before they start: not knowing what to build, and not knowing how to build it without a developer. Both are solvable in a weekend. The rest is customer conversations and persistence.

How to use it, concretely

1. Read Part One in one sitting (about forty minutes).
2. Skim all thirty idea cards. Mark any that make you think *“I know people with this problem.”*
3. Score your marked ideas with the five-question filter in Chapter 4. Keep the highest scorer.
4. Run the four-week sprint in Chapter 5 on that one idea. Do not start a second one.

That is the whole method. The rest is detail.

PART ONE

Foundations

What a micro SaaS is, why the model works for one person, and the tools that let you build one without writing code.

CHAPTER ONE

What a Micro SaaS Actually Is

A micro SaaS is a small software product, run by one to three people, that solves a narrow problem for a specific audience and charges a recurring subscription for it. That is the whole definition. Everything else is consequence.

Industry analysts generally describe the category as software businesses run by solo founders or teams of fewer than five, earning recurring revenue in the low thousands to low hundreds of thousands per month. What makes them structurally different from ordinary startups is not size alone — it is that staying small is the design goal, not a phase to grow out of.

Micro SaaS versus traditional SaaS

Dimension	Traditional SaaS	Micro SaaS
Team	10–100+ people, specialised roles	1–3 people; the founder builds, sells and supports
Market	Broad and horizontal — “a CRM for everyone”	A niche inside a niche — “a CRM for independent music teachers”
Funding	Venture capital, multiple rounds	Bootstrapped; usually under $1,000 before first revenue
Goal	Hypergrowth, then an exit	Profitability and durability; exit optional
Time to launch	6–24 months	4–12 weeks; sometimes a weekend
Feature set	Suite of capabilities	One thing, done exceptionally well

A useful phrase from the indie community: you are building a **surgical instrument, not a Swiss Army knife**. The narrower the blade, the more someone will pay for it.

The four traits every good micro SaaS shares

1. Narrow enough to own

A product aimed at everyone competes with funded companies that can outspend you indefinitely. A product aimed at tattoo artists, or immigration consultants, or independent pharmacy owners, competes with a spreadsheet. The narrower your audience, the easier it is to find your first ten customers, to write marketing copy that lands, and to build something that feels custom-made.

2. Painful enough to pay for

An inconvenience is not a business. The test is whether the problem currently costs your customer time or money *this week*. A task that eats an hour of a professional's day is comfortably worth $20–$50 a month to eliminate. A mild annoyance is worth nothing, no matter how elegant your solution.

3. Recurring enough to compound

Subscriptions beat one-time sales for solo builders for two reasons. Revenue becomes predictable, and renewals tell you the truth about whether people actually use the thing. A one-time purchase can hide a product nobody opens twice.

4. Simple enough to ship fast

If your minimum version needs ten features to be useful, it is not a micro SaaS. Scope creep before launch is the single most common reason solo builders never ship at all.

> WHAT A MICRO SAAS IS NOT
>
> **Not an agency.** If revenue stops when you stop working, that is a service business. Fine business — different book.
>
> **Not a template or digital download.** A Notion template sold once is a product sale, not software as a service. It becomes one only when there is an ongoing hosted service attached.
>
> **Not a marketplace.** Two-sided markets need liquidity on both sides before either side gets value. That is a much harder first year for one person.
>
> **Not a thin wrapper.** A page that passes a prompt to a language model and returns the answer has no defensibility. What makes an AI-powered tool a business is the workflow, the niche knowledge and the integrations around the model — not the model.

Where the money actually comes from

Fifty customers at $50 a month is $2,500 in monthly recurring revenue. That is a real business, and it is fifty people — a number you can reach by hand, one conversation at a time, without a marketing budget. This is the mathematics that makes micro SaaS possible for someone with a day job.

It also explains the strong bias in this book toward business customers over consumers. Businesses pay monthly for tools that save time or make money, they churn less because switching is disruptive, and they generate fewer support tickets per dollar of revenue. A consumer product at $9 a month needs roughly three hundred customers to match the same result.

CHAPTER TWO

The 2026 Opportunity — and the Honest Odds

The tailwinds are real. The failure rate is also real. You should understand both before you spend a weekend on this.

Why the timing is genuinely good

Three things changed at once, and they compound.

Building got cheap. No-code and AI-assisted platforms now handle the parts that used to require an engineer: databases, user accounts, permissions, payments, hosting. Industry analyses suggest a large and growing share of new applications are now built on no-code foundations, and a meaningful proportion of successful micro SaaS launches involve no hand-written code at all.

Buyers got pickier in your favour. Companies increasingly prefer one specialised tool that solves one operational problem over an expensive suite that solves forty problems adequately. That preference is the entire micro SaaS thesis.

The category grew. The micro SaaS segment is commonly projected to grow from roughly $15.7 billion in 2024 to around $59.6 billion by 2030 — approximately 30% annually. Within the broader SaaS market, the smallest companies report the fastest median growth rates: businesses under $1 million in annual recurring revenue have posted the highest median growth of any revenue bracket.

Now the uncomfortable part

Analyses of large samples of micro SaaS products consistently find a distribution that looks roughly like this:

Outcome	Share of products	What it means in practice
Under $1K MRR	Around 70%	Never reaches sustainability; most are quietly abandoned
$1K–$10K MRR	Roughly half of the rest	The “lifestyle business” band — a real side income, sometimes a salary
$10K–$100K MRR	Around 15%	A full-time business, often with one or two hires
Above $100K MRR	Around 5%	Rare; usually years of compounding, not a lucky launch

Read that table honestly. The most likely outcome of building a micro SaaS is that it does not make meaningful money. That is not a reason to avoid it — the downside is a few hundred dollars and some weekends, and the skills transfer — but it is a reason to be ruthless about the one variable that actually separates the groups.

THE VARIABLE THAT DECIDES WHICH GROUP YOU LAND IN

Across every analysis of failed micro SaaS products, the same cause dominates: **the founder built before validating.** Weeks of work poured into a product, then the discovery that nobody will pay. The fix is unglamorous and cheap — ten customer conversations and a landing page, before you open a single builder tool. Chapter 5 is that process, step by step.

What the winners have in common

- **They are boring.** A recurring theme in founder communities is that unglamorous vertical tools for unglamorous industries consistently outperform trend-chasing AI wrappers. Invoice chasing for plumbers beats another AI writing assistant.
- **The founder had unfair knowledge.** Domain expertise is the most reliable predictor of success. If you have spent five years inside an industry, that is your edge — not your technical skill, which you do not have anyway.
- **They charged early.** Charging from the first customer, even at a discount, is the only honest validation signal. "I'd definitely pay for that" is not data. A card on file is data.
- **They solved one problem.** The product that shipped in four weeks and got feedback beat the product that was still being perfected at month six.

What it costs to find out

The honest budget for a solo micro SaaS before revenue is modest — typically somewhere in the range of $50 to $150 a month, and often less if you stay on free tiers during validation:

Item	Typical monthly	Notes
App builder	$0–$79	Free tiers are usually enough to validate
Database / backend	$0–$25	Generous free tiers are standard
Automation tool	$0–$29	Free tier covers early volume
Payments	$0	Per-transaction fees only, after you earn
Domain & email	$10–$20	Your only unavoidable cost
Total before revenue	**Under $100**	Verify current pricing with each vendor

Compare that to the cost of the alternative: hiring a developer to build the same MVP. The asymmetry is the point. You are risking a few hundred dollars to test a business idea. Very few other business models offer that.

CHAPTER THREE

Your No-Code Toolkit

You do not need to learn twenty tools. You need one tool per layer, and there are six layers. Pick one from each column and you have a complete stack.

The six layers of a micro SaaS

Layer	What it does	Common choices
1. Marketing site	The public page that explains and sells the product	Webflow, Framer, Carrd, WordPress
2. The app	The screens your paying users log into	Bubble, Softr, Glide, Knack, Adalo, AI app builders
3. The data	Where records actually live	Airtable, Supabase, Google Sheets, builder's own database
4. Automation	Connects everything; runs scheduled jobs and AI steps	Make, Zapier, n8n
5. Payments	Subscriptions, plan gating, invoices	Stripe, Paddle, Lemon Squeezy
6. Email	Onboarding, notifications, alerts	Resend, Postmark, Brevo, Mailchimp

Choosing your app builder

This is the only decision that genuinely matters. The rest are interchangeable. Match the tool to the *shape* of your product, not to marketing claims.

Tool	Best for	Weakness	Rough pricing
Softr	Client portals and B2B dashboards where each customer sees only their own rows. Connects to Airtable, Sheets, Supabase. Roles, permissions and Stripe billing built in.	Custom logic is limited; inherits the limits of the data source behind it	Free tier; paid from roughly \$49–\$59/mo
Glide	Turning existing spreadsheet data into a clean app fast. Excellent for validating in hours rather than weeks.	Row limits per tier; produces a web app, not an App Store listing	Free tier; paid tiers from roughly \$19–\$99/mo, business tiers higher

Bubble	Genuinely custom products with their own database and complex multi-step logic. The most flexible general-purpose option.	Steepest learning curve; usage-based compute billing; performance complaints at scale	Free to start; paid tiers plus workload charges
Knack	Database-heavy apps: forms, records, dashboards, role-based permissions.	Less design flexibility than Webflow-class tools	Paid tiers by records and users
AI app builders	Describing a product in plain English and getting a working full-stack app with auth, database and payments.	Newest and fastest-moving category; output quality varies; you inherit code you cannot read	Typically $25–$79/mo
FlutterFlow / Adalo	Products that genuinely need to be in the App Store or Play Store with push notifications.	App store review adds friction; most micro SaaS does not need this	Free tiers; paid tiers vary

A RULE THAT WILL SAVE YOU WEEKS

Build your signup flow and one core workflow in a single day on your chosen tool. If it already feels heavy at that stage, it gets worse from there — switch tools now, while you have almost nothing to migrate.

The honest limitation nobody puts on the landing page

No-code and AI builders reliably get you to somewhere around 60–70% of a real production SaaS. The first 60–70% is structure: screens, forms, basic records, simple flows. Tools handle that beautifully.

The remaining 30–40% is invisible until it breaks. Multi-role authentication. What happens when an integration fails halfway through. Data correctness when two things update at once. Security when a customer's data must never be visible to another customer. Payment webhooks that must be handled correctly or subscriptions silently desynchronise.

This is not a reason to avoid no-code. It is a reason to know where the wall is. For a product with under a few hundred customers and one user role, you will likely never hit it. If you get past that point, you will have revenue — and revenue buys a contractor to handle the last 30%.

The AI layer

Most ideas in Part Two include an AI step: summarise this, draft that, extract these fields. You do not need to build or host a model. In practice, your automation tool calls a commercial model's API, passes it your prompt and the user's data, and returns the result to your app. It is one node in a Make or n8n scenario.

Two warnings. First, budget for it — API calls cost real money per use, so price your plans with usage limits. Second, the AI is never the product. The product is the workflow around it: the niche-specific prompt, the formatting, the integration, the fact that it lands in the customer's existing process. Anyone can call the same API. Not everyone knows what agency owners need in a client report.

A starter stack that covers most of this book

If you want a default to stop deliberating: **Airtable** for data, **Softr** for the customer-facing app, **Make** for automation and AI calls, **Stripe** for billing, **Carrd or Framer** for the marketing page, and **Brevo or Resend** for email. That combination will deliver a large share of the thirty ideas that follow, costs very little to start, and can be learned in a weekend.

CHAPTER FOUR

How to Read the Thirty Ideas

Part Two is a reference section, not a story. Every card has the same fields so you can compare thirty ideas quickly and discard twenty-seven of them without guilt.

Anatomy of an idea card

Field	What it tells you
The problem	The specific pain, and what the customer does today instead. If this does not sound like a real week in someone's life, skip the card.
Who pays	The narrowest sensible buyer. Narrow it further if you can — specificity is an advantage, not a constraint.
Minimum version	Three features. Not four. This is what you build in the first sprint; everything else waits for a paying customer to ask.
No-code stack	One workable combination. It is a suggestion, not a prescription — substitute freely from Chapter 3.
Price	An indicative monthly range based on what comparable tools charge. Your first customers should pay less; your tenth should pay this.
Build & difficulty	Realistic effort for a non-technical builder, assuming evenings and weekends. Difficulty is relative to the other cards, not to software generally.
First customers	Where these people already gather. Distribution is harder than building; this field matters more than it looks.

The five-question filter

Before committing to any idea, answer these five questions honestly. This filter, popularised in bootstrapped-founder communities, catches most bad decisions before they cost you a month.

Question	Green light	Red light
Do you understand the customer?	You have been this customer, or worked beside them	You are guessing at their pain from a blog post
Can you find ten of them to talk to this week?	You know exactly where they gather	You would have to buy a list
Can you build a first version in two	One core feature does the job	It needs ten features before it is

weekends?		useful
Would *you* pay the target price for it?	Yes, without hesitating	It feels like a nice-to-have
Does a paying market already exist?	Competitors exist and charge money	You would have to teach the market it has a problem

Scoring. Four or more green lights: start. Three: proceed carefully and validate hard. Fewer than three: move to the next card. A blank version of this scorecard is in Appendix C.

> **ON COMPETITORS**
>
> New founders panic when they find an existing product. That reaction is backwards. Competitors prove a market pays money for this — the most expensive thing to prove yourself. What should worry you is *no* competitor, or a competitor with venture funding who can lose money longer than you can survive. The sweet spot is two to five small competitors serving a general audience, while you serve one specific slice of it better than any of them.

How the groups are organised

The thirty ideas are grouped by *who pays* rather than by technology, because your first ten customers are a distribution problem, not a build problem. If you already have access to one of these audiences — through your job, your network or a community you belong to — start with that group and ignore the other five.

Group	Audience	Why it is attractive
A	Freelancers & solo professionals	Enormous population; easy to reach online; low-friction buying decisions
B	Agencies & consultants	Real budgets; problems that cost billable hours; strong willingness to pay
C	Creators & content teams	High volume of repetitive work; publicly visible and easy to contact
D	Local & vertical businesses	Least competition; sticky once adopted; often underserved by software
E	SaaS & startup founders	They understand subscriptions and buy quickly; you may already be one
F	Career, data & compliance	Urgent, deadline-driven problems people will pay to make disappear

One last instruction before Part Two: **read all thirty, then choose one.** Not three in parallel. A solo founder's scarcest resource is attention, and the failure mode of an idea book is a founder with six half-built products and no customers.

PART TWO

The 30 Ideas

Thirty specific products, each with a named customer, a minimum version, a no-code stack and a price. Read them all. Choose one.

GROUP A · IDEAS 1–5

Tools for Freelancers & Solo Professionals

Roughly seventy-three million people freelance in the United States alone, and the great majority run their businesses out of email, a document folder and memory. They buy quickly, they buy on their own authority, and they are easy to reach online. The trade-off is price sensitivity: keep these products under $30 a month and make the value obvious in the first session.

01

Invoice & Payment Chaser for Freelancers

Send the invoice, then let software do the awkward part.

Freelancers build invoices by hand in a word processor, email them, and then either forget to follow up or spend weeks writing uncomfortable reminder emails. Late payment is the single most common cashflow problem in solo businesses, and the fix is not accounting software — it is polite, automatic, escalating persistence that nobody has to feel bad about sending.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Create a branded invoice from a short form and email it as a PDF with a payment link
- Automatic reminder sequence at 3, 7, 14 and 30 days overdue, with tone escalating from friendly to firm
- A simple dashboard showing paid, pending and overdue, with total outstanding

NO-CODE STACK

Airtable (invoices) + Softr (dashboard) + Make (reminder scheduling) + Stripe (payment links and your own billing) + Brevo (transactional email)

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Freelance designers, writers, developers and consultants billing 3–15 clients a month	**$12–$19 per month**	**2–3 weekends**	**Low**	**Freelance subreddits, Dribbble and Behance communities, freelance Slack and Discord groups, LinkedIn posts about late-paying clients (they are everywhere and they attract comments)**

SHARPEN IT

Differentiate by vertical — invoice chasing tuned for photographers, with shoot dates and usage-rights line items, beats a generic tool.

02

Client Portal for Solo Consultants

One branded link that replaces forty email threads.

A consultant with six clients manages each one across email threads, a shared cloud folder, a chat channel and a spreadsheet. Clients ask "where are we on this?" and the answer takes twenty minutes to assemble. A simple branded portal where each client logs in and sees only their own project status, files and messages replaces that chaos and makes a one-person business look considerably larger than it is.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Per-client login showing only that client's records, files and project status
- File upload and download in both directions, with a simple activity log
- A status timeline the consultant updates in one click and the client can check without asking

NO-CODE STACK

Airtable or Supabase (data) + Softr (portal, with row-level permissions and Stripe billing built in) + Make (notification emails)

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Solo consultants, small agencies and fractional executives with 3–20 concurrent clients	**$29–$49 per month**	**3–4 weekends**	**Medium**	**Consulting communities on LinkedIn, fractional-executive networks, local business chambers, and directly through consultants you already know — this sells best via demo**

SHARPEN IT

Client-facing data isolation is a hard requirement here, not a feature. Test it obsessively before launch.

03

Deposit-Taking Booking Tool for Niche Specialists

Calendly does not collect a deposit, take an intake form, or understand your trade.

Generic scheduling tools handle a thirty-minute call perfectly and a specialist appointment badly. A tattoo artist needs a deposit, a reference-image upload and a healing-timeline follow-up. A nutritionist needs an intake questionnaire before session one. A legal consultant needs a conflict-check question. No-shows cost these professionals real money, and a deposit eliminates most of them. Build the booking tool for exactly one of these trades.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Public booking page with availability and service types specific to the trade
- Deposit collection at the moment of booking, with clear cancellation terms
- Custom intake form attached to each booking, delivered to the practitioner before the appointment

NO-CODE STACK

Softr or Bubble (booking flow) + Airtable (bookings and availability) + Stripe (deposits and subscriptions) + Make (reminders via email or WhatsApp)

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
One specialist trade — tattoo artists, nutritionists, physiotherapists, music teachers or immigration consultants	**$29–$59 per month**	**4–6 weekends**	**Medium–High**	**Trade-specific Facebook groups and Instagram hashtags, professional association directories, trade shows and local practitioner meetups**

SHARPEN IT

Specialised booking tools charge several times what generic ones do, because the workflow fit is the product.

04

Proposal & Contract Generator for Freelancers

Brief in, branded proposal and signable contract out, in ten minutes.

Winning work requires a proposal. Most freelancers either reuse an old document and forget to change the client's name, or spend three hours writing from scratch for a job they may not get. A tool that takes a short brief — scope, timeline, budget, deliverables — and produces a formatted, branded, editable proposal with a matching contract turns a three-hour task into a twenty-minute one.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Structured brief form that generates a formatted proposal with editable sections
- Reusable service and pricing blocks the user defines once
- Shareable proposal link with view tracking, plus simple accept or decline

NO-CODE STACK

Bubble or Softr (app) + an AI model API called through Make (drafting) + a document API or HTML-to-PDF service (output) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Freelancers and one-person studios sending 3–10 proposals a month	**$19–$39 per month**	**3–5 weekends**	**Medium**	**Freelance communities, design and writing Slack groups, YouTube and blog content on “how to write a proposal that wins” — this idea markets itself through templates**

SHARPEN IT

View tracking is the feature people talk about. Knowing a client opened the proposal three times is genuinely useful.

05

Retainer Scope & Hours Tracker

Tells you the moment a retainer client goes from profitable to unprofitable.

Retainers quietly bleed money. A client signs for ten hours a month and is at fourteen by week three, and the freelancer notices at invoice time, when it is too late to say anything. A lightweight tool that tracks hours against the agreed scope and alerts both sides at 80% consumption turns an awkward conversation into a neutral notification the software sent.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Define a retainer per client: hours or deliverables included, rate, renewal date
- Fast time or task logging, ideally from a phone in under ten seconds
- Automatic alerts at 80% and 100% consumption, to the freelancer and optionally the client

NO-CODE STACK

Glide or Softr (mobile-friendly logging) + Airtable (retainers and entries) + Make (threshold alerts) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Freelancers and small studios working on monthly retainers rather than fixed projects	**$15–$29 per month**	**2–3 weekends**	**Low**	**Freelance and agency communities, and content aimed at the phrase “scope creep” — a search term with strong commercial intent and an emotional charge**

SHARPEN IT

Sell it as protecting the relationship, not as surveillance. The framing changes the conversion rate.

GROUP B · IDEAS 6–10

Tools for Agencies & Consultants

Agencies are the best-value audience in this book. Every hour their team spends on reporting, proposals or onboarding is an hour not billed to a client, which means your product has a direct and calculable return. They will pay \$50–\$200 a month without much negotiation if you can show the hours saved. Fifty agencies at \$99 is a full-time income.

06

Automated Client Reporting for Marketing Agencies

The report the client expects, without a person assembling it.

Agencies lose four to eight hours per client every month pulling numbers from analytics platforms, ad dashboards and social tools into a formatted report that a client skims for two minutes. It is pure busywork with no strategic value, but clients expect it and the agency cannot stop. A tool that pulls the data on a schedule, drops it into a branded template and emails a PDF removes the task entirely.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Connect one or two data sources per client and store them on a schedule
- Branded report template with a short automated commentary paragraph
- Scheduled monthly delivery as PDF or shareable link, with the agency's logo, not yours

NO-CODE STACK

Make (data pulls and scheduling) + Airtable (stored metrics) + Softr (dashboard) + an AI model API (commentary) + HTML-to-PDF service + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Marketing and social agencies with 5–50 clients	**\$79–\$199 per month**	**5–8 weekends**	**High**	**Agency owner communities on LinkedIn, agency-focused Facebook groups, marketing conferences, and direct outreach — agency owners answer cold email about saving billable hours**

SHARPEN IT

The highest-value idea in Group B and the hardest to build. Start with one data source and one vertical of agency, not all of them.

07

AI Proposal Generator for Agencies

Turn a discovery-call summary into a branded pitch document before the follow-up.

Agencies spend three to five hours writing a custom proposal for every prospect, most of which do not convert. The structure is nearly identical each time — understanding of the problem, approach, scope, timeline, team, pricing, terms — and only the specifics change. A tool that takes a brief and produces a formatted, on-brand proposal with editable sections compresses the task to under thirty minutes.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Brief input form covering client, problem, scope, budget range and timeline
- AI-drafted proposal following the agency's own reusable structure and tone
- Branded export plus a shareable link with open tracking

NO-CODE STACK

Bubble or Softr + AI model API via Make + document generation service + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Small digital, marketing and creative agencies pitching 5–20 times a month	$39–$79 per month	4–6 weekends	Medium	Agency communities, LinkedIn content about pitch win rates, partnerships with agency coaches and consultants who already sell to this audience

SHARPEN IT

Let agencies upload two or three past winning proposals to set the tone. That single feature is the difference between generic output and something they will actually send.

08

Testimonial & Case Study Collector

Ask, collect, approve and embed — without a single awkward follow-up email.

Social proof converts better than anything else on a website, and almost nobody collects it systematically. The request feels awkward, the client forgets, the reply arrives as three sentences in an email thread that never makes it to the site. A tool that sends a structured request, collects text or video, handles approval and produces an embeddable widget makes the whole cycle automatic.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Branded request page with guided prompts, accepting text or a short video
- Approval queue so nothing goes public without the owner's consent
- One-line embeddable widget with two or three display layouts

NO-CODE STACK

Softr or Bubble (collection pages) + Airtable (submissions) + a video upload service + Make (request sequences) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Course creators, B2B consultants, agencies or SaaS founders — pick one and optimise the request copy for them	$15–$29 per month	3–4 weekends	Medium	Course creator and consultant communities, LinkedIn, and content targeting “how to ask for a testimonial” — a high-intent, low-competition search area

SHARPEN IT

Established competitors exist here. Win by owning one audience completely, with request copy and templates written specifically for them.

09

White-Label SEO Audit Report Generator

A readable site audit in plain English, priced for businesses that cannot afford an agency.

Small business owners are told constantly that they need SEO. Agency retainers start around two thousand dollars a month, and free tools produce technical output that means nothing to a restaurant owner. A tool that scans a site, identifies the ten issues that matter and explains each one in plain language — what it is, why it costs money, what to do — fills a genuine gap. Sell it to owners directly, or white-labelled to the freelancers who serve them.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Enter a URL and receive a scored audit covering the highest-impact issues
- Plain-English explanation and a prioritised fix list for each finding
- Branded PDF export, with the reseller's logo on white-label plans

NO-CODE STACK

Make or n8n (calling third-party SEO and site-speed APIs) + Airtable + Softr + AI model API (plain-English rewriting) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Small business owners and local service providers; or freelancers and small agencies who resell audits	**$15–$29 direct, $49–$99 white-label**	**4–6 weekends**	**Medium–High**	**Local business Facebook groups, chambers of commerce, and freelancer communities for the white-label tier — resellers are the faster path to revenue**

SHARPEN IT

Your API costs scale with usage. Cap scans per plan from day one or the unit economics break.

10

Client Onboarding Workflow Tool

Every new client gets the same excellent first two weeks, without anyone remembering to make it happen.

The two weeks after a contract is signed set the tone for the entire engagement, and most small agencies improvise them. Kickoff questionnaire, asset collection, access credentials, introductions, first milestone — all handled ad hoc, all chased manually. A tool that turns onboarding into a reusable template with automatic reminders makes a small firm feel like a well-run one and cuts days of coordination per client.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Reusable onboarding template of tasks and forms, applied to each new client
- Client-facing checklist showing what is needed from them and what is done
- Automatic reminders to whichever side is holding up the next step

NO-CODE STACK

Airtable (templates and instances) + Softr (client view) + Make (reminders and task generation) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Agencies, consultancies and professional services firms onboarding 2–10 clients a month	**$39–$89 per month**	**3–5 weekends**	**Medium**	**Agency owner groups, operations-focused consultants, and partnerships with agency coaches**

SHARPEN IT

Natural upsell path from Idea 2. Many founders build the portal first and add onboarding later.

GROUP C · IDEAS 11–15

Tools for Creators & Content Teams

The creator economy runs on repetitive work: adapting one piece of content for five platforms, planning next month's calendar, chasing brand deals, reporting to sponsors. Creators are unusually easy to find and contact — their audience size and niche are public. The catch is churn: creators quit, pivot and cancel more than businesses do, so favour annual plans.

11

Newsletter-to-Social Repurposing Tool

One newsletter issue becomes eight platform-native posts, without rewriting anything.

Newsletter writers spend two to three hours a week manually adapting content they have already written for Twitter, LinkedIn and Instagram, because each platform demands a different length, tone and structure. The writing is done; only the reshaping remains. A tool that ingests an issue and produces genuinely platform-appropriate posts eliminates the work entirely.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Paste a URL or text and generate posts for two or three platforms with correct formatting
- Editable output with tone controls and a saved brand-voice setting
- A simple queue with copy-to-clipboard, or scheduling via an integration

NO-CODE STACK

Bubble or Softr + AI model API via Make + Airtable + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Newsletter creators with 500 or more subscribers who also maintain social presence	**\$9–\$29 per month**	**2–4 weekends**	**Low–Medium**	**Newsletter and creator communities, ConvertKit and beehiiv user groups, Twitter and LinkedIn creator circles — and the newsletters themselves, which are public and easy to contact**

SHARPEN IT

The generic version is crowded. Pick one platform pair and one niche — B2B founders writing for LinkedIn, for instance — and tune the prompts until the output needs no editing.

12

Content Calendar & Idea Engine for a Niche

A month of relevant post ideas, generated for your specific industry, on a drag-and-drop calendar.

Consistency is the strongest growth factor on every platform, and idea generation is the bottleneck that breaks it. Creators in specific verticals — fitness, personal finance, real estate, education — run out of angles by week two and post nothing. A tool that generates a month of ideas grounded in that niche, and lays them on a calendar the user can rearrange, keeps the pipeline full.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Generate a month of post ideas from a niche, platform and audience input
- Drag-and-drop calendar with status tracking from idea to published
- Save recurring formats and series the user posts regularly

NO-CODE STACK

Glide or Bubble (calendar interface) + Airtable + AI model API via Make + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Niche content creators and the social media managers who run accounts for them	**$12–$19 per month**	**3–4 weekends**	**Medium**	**Niche creator communities on Instagram and TikTok, social media manager Facebook groups, and freelance SMM job boards**

SHARPEN IT

Free general-purpose AI tools do a passable version of this. Your defensibility is the niche library: real formats that work in that specific industry, not generic prompts.

13

Cross-Platform Analytics for One Creator Type

The three numbers your kind of creator actually needs, on one screen.

Standard analytics answer generic questions. A podcaster needs to know which episode topics drive cross-platform growth. A newsletter writer needs subscriber value over time, not open rates. An online seller needs seasonality-adjusted comparisons, because January and November are not comparable months. Each of these creators currently opens four dashboards and does arithmetic by hand. Build the one dashboard for one of them.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Connect two or three platforms and pull core metrics on a schedule
- Three to five derived metrics that matter to this creator type and exist nowhere else
- A weekly email digest with the numbers and what changed

NO-CODE STACK

Make or n8n (API pulls) + Airtable or Supabase + Softr or Glide (dashboard) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
One creator type only — podcasters, newsletter writers, YouTubers or online sellers	**$19–$39 per month**	**4–6 weekends**	**Medium–High**	**Platform-specific communities, podcast and newsletter directories, creator Discords**

SHARPEN IT

Depends entirely on third-party APIs. Check access terms and rate limits before you build — some platforms restrict or charge for the data you need.

14

Brand Deal & Sponsorship Manager for Creators

Every deliverable, deadline and invoice for every sponsor, in one place.

A creator with six brand deals is tracking six sets of deliverables, usage rights, exclusivity windows, deadlines and payment terms across email and memory. Deliverables get missed, invoices go unsent, and renewal conversations happen without any record of what was actually delivered. A purpose-built tracker converts that anxiety into a checklist and makes the creator look professional to the brands paying them.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Deal record: brand, fee, deliverables, deadlines, exclusivity and usage terms
- Deliverable checklist with reminders as deadlines approach
- One-click sponsor recap showing what was delivered and how it performed

NO-CODE STACK

Airtable + Softr or Glide + Make (reminders) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Creators earning meaningful sponsorship revenue, and the small talent managers who represent them	**$19–$49 per month**	**3–4 weekends**	**Medium**	**Creator communities, influencer marketing groups, and talent managers — a manager with twenty creators is twenty seats in one conversation**

SHARPEN IT

Talent managers are the better wedge. Multi-creator accounts are worth several times a single-creator seat.

15

AI Content Brief Generator for SEO Teams

A full writing brief from one keyword, in five minutes instead of two hours.

Before any article gets written, someone spends one to two hours producing a brief: target keyword, search intent, competing pages, subtopics to cover, suggested headings, word count, internal links. Content demands have risen sharply and brief production has not scaled with them, so writers either wait or work without direction. A tool that produces a complete brief from a keyword removes the bottleneck.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Keyword input producing intent analysis, subtopic list and a heading structure
- Competitor page summary showing what the ranking pages cover
- Export to a document format writers already use

NO-CODE STACK

Make or n8n (SERP data APIs) + AI model API + Airtable + Softr + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Content managers, SEO agencies and in-house content teams publishing 8 or more articles a month	**$29–$49 per month**	**4–5 weekends**	**Medium–High**	**SEO communities and newsletters, content marketing Slack groups, agency owner networks**

SHARPEN IT

Sell seats, not accounts. Content teams have three to ten people who all need this.

GROUP D · IDEAS 16–20

Tools for Local & Vertical Businesses

This is the least crowded and most durable group. A salon owner, a physiotherapy clinic or a small logistics firm is rarely anyone's target customer, which is exactly why the opportunity survives. Sales cycles are slower and often require a phone call or a demo, but retention is excellent: once a business runs its operations on your tool, it does not casually switch.

16

Multi-Platform Review Dashboard for Local Businesses

Every review from every platform in one inbox, answered without switching tabs.

A restaurant owner checks Google, then a travel site, then a social page, then a delivery app — four logins, four interfaces, thirty to sixty minutes a week, and reviews still get missed. Unanswered negative reviews cost real revenue. A single dashboard that aggregates reviews, alerts on anything below a threshold and lets the owner reply in place is a proven, paid category with room for a simpler, cheaper entrant.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Aggregate reviews from two or three platforms into one feed
- Instant alert on any review below a chosen star rating
- AI-suggested reply drafts the owner edits and approves before posting

NO-CODE STACK

Make or n8n (platform APIs) + Airtable + Softr + AI model API (reply drafts) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Independent restaurants, salons, clinics, gyms and multi-location local chains	**$29–$49 per location, per month**	**4–6 weekends**	**Medium–High**	**Local business associations, restaurant and salon owner groups, local marketing consultants as resellers, and simple door-to-door or phone outreach in one city**

SHARPEN IT

Established tools charge in this range for a single location, which validates the price. Multi-location businesses are the profitable segment.

17

Vertical CRM for One Trade

A CRM that already knows how your industry works, because it was built for one.

Generic CRMs are built for sales pipelines and fit almost no service trade properly. A property manager needs lease renewals, maintenance requests and tenant communication. A landscaper needs seasonal recurring jobs, crew scheduling and site notes. A music teacher needs lesson schedules, term billing and parent contacts. Each currently uses a spreadsheet, because configuring a general CRM is harder than living without one.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Contact and job records using that trade's actual vocabulary and fields
- The one recurring workflow that defines the trade — renewals, seasonal jobs, lesson terms
- Mobile-friendly views, because most of these people work away from a desk

NO-CODE STACK

Airtable or Supabase + Softr or Glide (mobile-first) + Make (reminders and follow-ups) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
One trade, chosen deliberately — ideally one you have worked in or grew up around	$29–$79 per month	5–8 weekends	Medium–High	Trade associations, industry-specific Facebook groups, trade publications and local suppliers who already serve that trade and can introduce you

SHARPEN IT

The most durable idea in this book, and the one most dependent on genuine domain knowledge. Do not pick a trade you have only read about.

18

WhatsApp Appointment Reminder Bot

No-shows drop when the reminder arrives where people actually read messages.

Clinics, salons and tuition centres lose meaningful revenue to no-shows. Email reminders go unread and SMS is expensive in many markets. In large parts of the world, messaging apps have engagement rates that email cannot approach, yet most small businesses still send reminders by hand from a personal phone. A tool that connects a booking sheet to automated messaging reminders — with confirm and reschedule buttons — pays for itself in one recovered appointment.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Import or sync the appointment list from a sheet or booking tool
- Automated reminder at 24 hours and 2 hours, with confirm or reschedule replies
- A simple dashboard of confirmed, rescheduled and unanswered appointments

NO-CODE STACK

Google Sheets or Airtable + Make or n8n + a business messaging API + Softr (dashboard) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Clinics, salons, tuition centres, physiotherapists and diagnostic labs, especially in messaging-first markets	$19–$49 per month, plus messaging costs passed through	3–5 weekends	Medium	Local clinic and salon owners, healthcare practice associations, and direct sales in one city — this category sells well through demonstration

SHARPEN IT

Business messaging APIs require account approval and have per-message costs and template rules. Read the platform policy carefully before you promise anything.

19

Digital Menu & QR Ordering for Independent Restaurants

Update a price once and it changes on every table, instantly.

Small restaurants print menus, then discover a supplier price change makes three dishes unprofitable and the printing was wasted. Delivery platforms take a large cut and own the customer relationship. A simple hosted menu with a QR code, editable from a phone in seconds, plus optional table ordering that sends tickets to the kitchen, gives the owner control back at a fraction of platform commission.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Menu editor with categories, prices, photos and an availability toggle per item
- Generated QR code linking to a fast mobile menu page
- Optional table ordering that sends an order to a kitchen screen or phone

NO-CODE STACK

Airtable or Supabase + Softr or Glide (customer-facing page) + Make (order routing) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Independent restaurants, cafes, bars and cloud kitchens with one to five locations	**$19–$39 per location, per month**	**3–5 weekends**	**Medium**	**Local restaurant walkthroughs, restaurant owner associations, food-service supplier partnerships, and hospitality groups on social platforms**

SHARPEN IT

Page speed is the entire product. A menu that takes four seconds to load on a phone at a table will be abandoned by both customers and owners.

20

Compliance Deadline Tracker for Small Businesses

Never miss a filing, renewal or licence expiry again.

Small business owners in regulated sectors spend five to ten hours a month tracking regulatory changes, filing deadlines, licence renewals and certificate expiries — usually in a spreadsheet maintained from memory. A missed deadline costs penalties and sometimes a licence. A tool that holds the calendar, escalates reminders and stores the supporting documents removes an entire category of low-grade anxiety.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Deadline register by obligation type, with owner and due date
- Escalating reminders at 30, 14 and 3 days, to more than one person
- Document vault storing the certificate or proof of each completed filing

NO-CODE STACK

Airtable + Softr + Make (reminder escalation) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Small businesses in one regulated sector — food service, healthcare, logistics, construction or childcare	**$29–$79 per month**	**3–4 weekends**	**Medium**	**Industry associations, compliance consultants as resellers, sector-specific trade publications**

SHARPEN IT

Rules differ by jurisdiction, so start with one country or state. Never promise legal accuracy — you are a tracking tool, not an advisor, and your terms should say so plainly.

GROUP E · IDEAS 21–25

Tools for SaaS & Startup Founders

Founders understand subscriptions, evaluate quickly and buy without a procurement process. If you are building a micro SaaS, you already belong to this audience and know where it gathers. The warning is saturation — these are the most obvious ideas to the most software-literate people on the internet, so differentiate on a specific segment rather than on features.

21

Failed Payment Recovery Tool for Small SaaS

Recovers revenue that has already been earned and quietly disappears.

Every subscription business loses a meaningful share of monthly revenue to failed card payments — expired cards, insufficient funds, bank declines — and most small products rely on their payment processor's default retry logic, which is not optimised for recovery. Smart retry timing plus a well-written email sequence recovers a substantial portion of it. The value proposition is unusually easy to sell: pay us less than we recover.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Connect the payment processor and detect failed charges via webhooks
- Intelligent retry schedule rather than fixed intervals
- Branded dunning email sequence with a one-click card update link

NO-CODE STACK

Make or n8n (webhook handling and retry logic) + Airtable or Supabase + Softr (dashboard) + Stripe + Resend

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Small SaaS products, membership sites and subscription boxes with 100 or more subscribers	**\$49–\$99 per month, or a percentage of recovered revenue**	**5–7 weekends**	**High**	**Indie hacker and bootstrapper communities, SaaS founder forums, subscription-commerce groups**

SHARPEN IT

Webhook reliability is non-negotiable here. A missed webhook means a customer charged twice or cancelled wrongly. This is the idea most likely to hit the no-code wall — budget for help.

22

Feedback Board & Public Roadmap Widget

Feature requests in one place, voted on, with a roadmap customers can see.

Most early-stage products handle support in a chat tool and have no structured way to collect feature requests, work out which ones matter, or show customers what is coming. Requests get lost in conversations, the same one arrives fifteen times without anyone noticing, and customers feel ignored. One embeddable widget covering submission, voting and a public roadmap solves all three.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Embeddable submission widget with duplicate detection
- Upvoting and a sorted list by demand
- Public roadmap with planned, building and shipped columns

NO-CODE STACK

Bubble or Softr + Supabase or Airtable + Make (notifications) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Early-stage SaaS products and app developers with an engaged user base	$15–$29 per month	3–5 weekends	Medium	Indie hacker communities, product launch platforms, SaaS founder Slack and Discord groups

SHARPEN IT

Well-served by existing tools, which proves demand but means you must differentiate — on price, on radical simplicity, or on one under-served segment such as mobile apps or plugins.

23

Waitlist & Referral Launch System

Turn a launch signup form into a referral loop that grows itself.

Founders launching a product build a waitlist in an email tool and get a flat list of addresses with no growth mechanics. Every launch rebuilds the same thing from scratch: capture, referral links, position tracking, rewards for top referrers. An embeddable tool that provides all of it in ten minutes is a small purchase with an obvious payoff during a launch window.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Embeddable signup form issuing a unique referral link to each person
- Position tracking and a leaderboard, with position improving on successful referrals
- Reward tiers and an automatic email when someone reaches one

NO-CODE STACK

Bubble or Softr + Supabase or Airtable + Make + Resend + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Indie founders, product launchers, course creators and anyone running a pre-launch campaign	$19–$49 per month	3–4 weekends	Medium	Launch platforms, indie founder communities, and no-code and startup newsletters

SHARPEN IT

Usage is bursty — people subscribe for a launch month and cancel. Price monthly with no annual pretence, or bundle multiple launches into an annual plan to smooth revenue.

24

Lightweight Status Page Builder

The status page every SaaS needs, at a price early-stage companies can justify.

Every software product needs a public page showing whether the service is up, and every founder delays building one until the first outage, when customers are already emailing. Enterprise status page tools start around a hundred dollars a month, which is impossible to justify at ten customers. A simpler, cheaper version with uptime monitoring, incident posts and subscriber notifications covers ninety percent of the need.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Automated uptime checks on listed endpoints, with status shown publicly
- Manual incident posting with updates and a resolution timeline
- Email subscription so affected customers are notified without contacting support

NO-CODE STACK

Make or n8n (scheduled checks) + Supabase or Airtable + Softr or Bubble (public page) + Resend + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Early-stage SaaS companies, API providers and agencies hosting client applications	**$15–$29 per month**	**3–5 weekends**	**Medium**	**Indie hacker and developer communities, API directories, hosting and agency partnerships**

SHARPEN IT

Uncomfortable irony: your status page must be more reliable than the products it monitors. Host the public page independently of your own app.

25

Onboarding Email Sequence Builder

Generate a complete onboarding sequence for your product type in one sitting.

Email onboarding is repeatedly shown to be one of the highest-return retention levers in software, and most small products have a weak sequence written once at launch and never revisited. Founders know it matters and still deprioritise it, because writing seven good emails is a day of work they never schedule. A tool that generates a full sequence from the product type, user persona and activation goal removes the excuse.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Input product type, target user and the single activation action that predicts retention
- Generated sequence of five to seven emails with subject lines, timing and clear purpose per email
- Export to the common email platforms, or copy-ready blocks

NO-CODE STACK

Softr or Bubble + AI model API via Make + Airtable + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
SaaS founders, growth marketers and course creators	**$15–$39 per month, or a one-time fee with paid updates**	**2–4 weekends**	**Low–Medium**	**SaaS founder communities, growth marketing newsletters, no-code and indie maker groups**

SHARPEN IT

Retention is the weak point — someone builds a sequence once and cancels. Add ongoing value: performance benchmarks, seasonal rewrites, or A/B variants that justify a monthly charge.

GROUP F · IDEAS 26–30

Career, Data & Compliance Tools

These products solve problems with deadlines attached: a job application closing on Friday, a filing due next month, a meeting whose decisions nobody wrote down. Urgency makes people buy fast. Some of them are one-time needs rather than recurring ones, so pay particular attention to the retention note on each card.

26

Job Board for One Narrow Industry

Employers and candidates who actually fit each other, in one small room.

General job boards bury qualified candidates under volume and algorithmic filtering, and employers pay for reach they cannot use. A focused board for a single vertical — climate startups, healthcare technology, supply chain analytics, creative studios — delivers fewer and better matches on both sides. It is also the rare idea where the content itself does your marketing, because job listings rank well and get shared.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Submission and payment flow for a job posting, with approval before it goes live
- Clean, filterable listing page and individual job pages that index well
- Weekly email digest to candidates, which becomes the real asset

NO-CODE STACK

Airtable or Supabase + Softr or Webflow + Stripe + Brevo (digest emails)

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Employers in one specific industry, paying per posting or by subscription	**\$150–\$500 per posting, or a monthly employer subscription**	**2–4 weekends**	**Low–Medium**	**Seed the board manually by listing jobs you find elsewhere, build the candidate newsletter first, then approach employers once you can quote a subscriber number**

SHARPEN IT

Classic chicken-and-egg. Always build the candidate side first — an audience of two thousand relevant candidates is what employers are actually buying.

27

Resume Tailoring Tool for One Field

Rewrites a resume to match one specific job description, in the language that field uses.

Most applicants send an identical resume to every opening, and applicant tracking systems filter on language matched to the posting. Tailoring each application properly takes twenty to forty minutes, so almost nobody does it. A tool that rewrites the resume against a pasted job description — and knows the vocabulary of one specific field — converts a chore into a two-minute step.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Upload a resume and paste a job description; receive a tailored version with changes visible
- Keyword coverage score against the posting, with specific gaps named
- Export to clean, machine-readable formats

NO-CODE STACK

Bubble or Softr + AI model API via Make + document parsing service + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Active job seekers in one field, plus the career coaches who serve them	**$9–$15 per month, or a small per-use credit**	**2–3 weekends**	**Low–Medium**	**Field-specific career communities, university alumni groups, career coaches as resellers, and content aimed at people actively searching**

SHARPEN IT

Retention is structurally poor: people cancel the moment they get a job. Career coaches, who always have new clients, are the sustainable revenue line.

28

Meeting Action-Item Extractor

Who agreed to do what, by when — extracted from the transcript automatically.

After every meeting, someone reviews the recording or notes and writes up decisions and action items, which takes twenty to thirty minutes and often does not happen at all. Work then gets forgotten, or repeated. A tool that ingests a transcript and outputs a structured list of owners, tasks and deadlines — pushed straight into the team's task tool — addresses one of the most universal small frustrations in professional work.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Accept a transcript from any source and extract owners, tasks and dates
- Editable review screen, because getting this wrong is worse than not doing it
- Push approved items into one task tool, and email the summary to attendees

NO-CODE STACK

Make or n8n + AI model API + Airtable + Softr + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Remote teams, consultants and project managers running 5 or more meetings a week	**$15–$25 per seat, per month**	**3–5 weekends**	**Medium**	**Remote work communities, project management groups, consultancies, and integration directories of the task tools you support**

SHARPEN IT

Large horizontal players dominate general meeting AI. Compete by going vertical — the structured output a specific profession needs, formatted the way that profession expects.

29

Micro-Influencer Outreach Manager

Run thirty creator relationships properly without enterprise software.

A growing consumer brand wants to work with thirty small creators rather than one large one. Enterprise influencer platforms start in the hundreds of dollars a month and are built for teams, so the brand ends up managing everything in a spreadsheet: who was contacted, who replied, what was agreed, what shipped, what posted, what it cost. A focused tool covering discovery notes, outreach and campaign tracking fits exactly the segment the big platforms price out.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Creator database with niche, reach, rates, contact details and relationship notes
- Outreach templates with send tracking and follow-up reminders
- Campaign view showing deliverables, status, cost and results per creator

NO-CODE STACK

Airtable + Softr + Make (outreach sequences and reminders) + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Direct-to-consumer brands and small agencies running creator campaigns	$49–$149 per month	3–5 weekends	Medium	Direct-to-consumer brand communities, ecommerce groups, small agency networks, and marketplace seller forums

SHARPEN IT

Do not attempt automated creator discovery in version one. Brands already know who they want; they need the relationship managed, not the list generated.

30

Privacy Policy & Terms Generator for Indie Founders

The legal pages every product needs, generated in five minutes instead of ignored for a year.

Every website and app needs a privacy policy and terms of service. Non-lawyers either skip it, pay several hundred dollars for a lawyer, or paste a free generator's generic output that does not describe what their product actually does. Expanding data-protection regimes across jurisdictions have made this steadily more urgent for small operators who have no legal support at all.

MINIMUM VERSION — THREE FEATURES

- Guided questionnaire covering data collected, tools used, jurisdiction and business model
- Generated policy and terms as clean, editable, hostable pages
- Change alerts and regenerated versions when the product or the rules change

NO-CODE STACK

Softr or Bubble + Airtable (clause library) + Make + Stripe

WHO PAYS	PRICE	BUILD TIME	DIFFICULTY	FIRST CUSTOMERS
Indie founders, no-code builders, small agencies and anyone launching a digital product	$12–$29 per month, or a one-time fee with paid updates	3–4 weekends	Medium	Indie hacker and no-code communities, product launch platforms, and partnerships with app builder ecosystems whose users all face this

SHARPEN IT

Handle this one carefully. State clearly and repeatedly that you provide document templates, not legal advice, and consider having a lawyer review your clause library once. The recurring revenue comes from update alerts, not from the initial generation.

PART THREE

From Idea to Paying Customer

The part that decides whether you have a business or a hobby. Validation, building, pricing, distribution — and the mistakes to avoid.

CHAPTER FIVE

The Four-Week Validation Sprint

You have chosen one idea. Do not open a builder tool yet. The next four weeks decide whether this idea deserves your next three months, and they cost you almost nothing but honesty.

The dominant cause of micro SaaS failure is building before validating. This chapter is the antidote, and it is deliberately unglamorous.

Week 1 — Talk to people, not about your idea

Find ten to fifteen people who match the customer on your chosen card. Ask each for twenty minutes. Then, critically: **do not describe your solution.** Ask about their current workflow.

- “Walk me through how you handle [the task] today, step by step.”
- “How long did it take you last time? When did you last do it?”
- “What do you use for it now? What made you choose that?”
- “What's the most annoying part? What happens when it goes wrong?”
- “Have you ever paid for something to help with this? What happened?”

You are listening for two things. First, whether the pain is real and current — people describing a genuine problem give you specific recent examples, unprompted, with irritation in their voice. Vague agreement is a warning sign. Second, the **exact words they use**. Those words become your landing page headline. Write them down verbatim; do not improve them.

> **THE SIGNAL TO WATCH FOR**
>
> The strongest possible finding is that someone has already built a bad workaround — a spreadsheet with fourteen tabs, a set of calendar reminders, an intern who does it manually. People do not build workarounds for problems they do not care about. A workaround is a customer who has already decided the problem is worth effort; you are only competing with their patience.

If you cannot find ten people willing to talk about this problem, stop. That is the finding. The market is too small or too hard to reach, and no amount of building fixes either.

Week 2 — A landing page and a hundred visitors

Build one page. It should take an afternoon, not a week.

- **Headline:** the problem in your customers' own words from Week 1.
- **Three lines** on what the tool does. Not five features. Three lines.

- **A price**, visible. Hiding the price destroys the quality of the signal.
- **One email capture** with a specific call to action — “Get early access”.

Then drive fifty to a hundred targeted visitors: the communities from your idea card, relevant discussion threads where you contribute genuinely first, direct messages to people you spoke to in Week 1, a post on your own network. Not paid ads — you are testing the message, and paid traffic is noisy at this volume.

Reading the result: roughly twenty or more signups from a hundred targeted visitors is a real signal. A capture rate around five percent from cold traffic is the usual minimum worth continuing on. Under that, your problem statement is wrong, or your audience is wrong, or the pain is not sharp enough. Rewrite the headline using different Week 1 language and run it again before concluding the idea is dead.

Week 3 — Ask for money before the product exists

This is the week most people skip, and it is the only one that produces certain knowledge.

Go back to your waitlist. Offer founding-member access at roughly half the eventual price, payable now, for a product arriving in a stated number of weeks. Be completely honest that it does not exist yet and that they can have a refund at any point.

What happens	What it means
Several people pay	Validated, and partly funded. Build it.
“I'd definitely pay once it's built”	Not validated. This sentence costs nothing to say and predicts nothing.
“Is there a free version?”	Wrong audience, or the pain is mild. Consider a different segment.
Silence	The clearest answer of all. Move to your second-choice idea.

People who pay in advance are also your best early users. They have skin in the game, they answer your questions, and they tell you the truth about what is missing.

Week 4 — Build or kill

Make an explicit decision and write it down. **Build** if you got paying pre-orders or an unmistakably strong signup rate. **Iterate** if the interest was real but the framing was off — change the segment or the positioning and rerun Weeks 2 and 3, not the whole sprint. **Kill** if nobody paid and signups were weak.

Killing an idea in four weeks is a success, not a failure. You spent under a hundred dollars and twenty hours to avoid spending three months. Then go back to Part Two and pick your second choice, with sharper instincts than you had the first time.

CHAPTER SIX

Building the MVP Without Code

You validated. Now build the smallest thing that delivers the promise on your landing page — and nothing else.

The build sequence

1. **Write the one-sentence job.** "This product takes X and gives the user Y in under Z minutes." Pin it somewhere visible. Every feature request gets tested against it.
2. **List three screens.** Most micro SaaS needs exactly three: something you put data into, something that shows the result, and a settings or account page. If your list has eight, you have not finished scoping.
3. **Design the data first.** Open a spreadsheet and lay out your tables and columns before you touch a builder. Data structure is the one thing that is genuinely painful to change later, and it takes an hour to get right up front.
4. **Build the core workflow only.** The single path from input to value. No settings, no team accounts, no dark mode, no dashboard of charts nobody asked for.
5. **Add authentication and billing early, not last.** Founders routinely finish the product and then discover payments are the hard part. Wire up signup and a live subscription in week one, even with a placeholder product behind it.
6. **Do the unscalable parts manually.** If a step is hard to automate, do it by hand for your first ten customers. They will not know and will not care. Automate it only once it hurts.
7. **Ship at roughly seventy percent.** Give it to your founding members. They will tell you which missing thirty percent actually matters, and it is never the part you assumed.

> **THE MANUAL-FIRST PRINCIPLE**
>
> Some of the most successful small software businesses began as a human doing the work behind a form. If your product generates a report, it is entirely legitimate for version one to email you the request and for you to produce the report in twenty minutes and send it. You learn what the output should actually look like, which is information no amount of planning gives you. Automate afterwards, once the shape is settled.

A realistic four-week build

Week	Focus	Done when
Week 1	Data structure, signup, login, and a live Stripe subscription	You can charge your own card and get an account

Week 2	The core workflow: input screen through to output	One end-to-end run works, however ugly
Week 3	Automations, notification emails, error handling	It survives a customer using it wrongly
Week 4	Polish, onboarding, help text, founding-member invitations	Someone who has never seen it gets value alone

Three things beginners consistently get wrong

Building settings for problems nobody has. Every configurable option is a decision you push onto the user and a branch you must maintain. Choose sensible defaults and offer no toggle at all.

Treating the empty state as an afterthought. The first screen a new user sees is usually blank, and blank screens cause abandonment. Show sample data, a two-step getting-started prompt, or a pre-filled example. This single detail moves activation more than most features.

Ignoring what happens when something fails. An integration will time out. An AI call will return nonsense. A file will be the wrong format. Decide now what the user sees: a clear message and a way forward, not a spinner that never stops. Reliability, not features, is what people pay to keep.

Testing before you invite anyone

- Sign up as a brand new user in a private browser window and complete the full journey.
- Create two separate accounts and confirm neither can see any trace of the other's data. This is the most damaging bug class in no-code products — test it deliberately.
- Run a real subscription, then cancel it, and confirm access changes correctly both times.
- Submit garbage: empty fields, enormous files, wrong formats, special characters.
- Open it on a phone. A meaningful share of your users will, whether you designed for it or not.

CHAPTER SEVEN

Pricing Your Micro SaaS

Almost every first-time founder underprices, then discovers that low prices attract the most demanding customers and the least sustainable business.

Start from value, not from cost

Your hosting bill is irrelevant to your customer. What matters is what the problem costs them today. If your tool saves an agency six hours a month and their billing rate is eighty dollars an hour, you are removing roughly four hundred and eighty dollars of cost. Charging ninety-nine dollars for that is not expensive; it is a rounding error against the saving. Charging nineteen dollars signals that it probably does not work.

Audience	Workable range	Why
Consumers and job seekers	$5–$15/mo	Personal wallet, high price sensitivity, high churn
Freelancers and creators	$12–$39/mo	Business expense, but a small one; value must be immediate
Small businesses	$29–$79/mo	Compared against staff time; slower to decide, slow to leave
Agencies and B2B teams	$49–$199/mo	Clear return on billable hours; least price-sensitive group

Structure: keep it embarrassingly simple

Two plans. Occasionally three. Never five.

- **Starter** — the core job, with a usage limit that a real single user will not hit.
- **Pro** — higher limits plus the one or two features that heavier users always request.
- **Team** (only when asked for) — multiple seats, shared data, priority support.

Pick **one** limiting dimension and make it something the customer already counts: clients, reports, locations, seats, generations per month. If your pricing page needs a paragraph to explain, the structure is wrong.

> **ON FREE PLANS**
>
> A permanent free tier is a support burden funded by nobody, and free users of small products convert poorly. Prefer a fourteen-day free trial without a card, or a genuinely limited free tier that is useful once and then obviously insufficient. If your AI or API costs scale per use, a free tier can lose you money on every signup — model that before you offer one.

Rules that will save you real money

Raise prices for new customers, never for existing ones without warning. Grandfather your early supporters permanently and tell them so. It costs you little and buys enormous goodwill from the people most likely to recommend you.

Offer annual billing at roughly two months free. It improves cash flow when you need it most and removes twelve chances to cancel. For seasonal or bursty products, it is the difference between a business and a series of one-month subscriptions.

Test your price upward before you assume it is too high. If your first ten customers all say yes immediately, you are priced too low. Some hesitation at signup is the sign of a correct price.

Charge from the first customer. A free beta with a promise to charge later trains people to expect free and gives you no information. Even a heavily discounted paid beta tells you the truth.

The number that actually matters

Not signups. Not traffic. **Monthly recurring revenue**, and the rate at which customers leave. Thirty customers at forty-nine dollars is roughly fourteen hundred and seventy dollars a month. If four leave every month, you are running to stand still; if one leaves, you are compounding. Small products live or die on retention, and retention is a product problem long before it is a marketing one.

CHAPTER EIGHT

Finding Your First Ten Customers

Building is the easy half. Almost every abandoned micro SaaS was abandoned because nobody arrived, not because the software did not work.

The first ten are found by hand

There is no scalable channel at this stage and looking for one is a form of procrastination. Your first ten customers come from direct human contact: people you interviewed in Week 1, people in communities you belong to, people who replied to your posts, people your existing contacts introduce you to. Expect to speak to a hundred people to get ten customers. That ratio is normal and it improves.

The channels that work for products this size

Channel	How it actually works	The mistake to avoid
Communities	Join where your customers already are. Answer questions about the problem for weeks before mentioning your product.	Posting a launch link on day one. You get removed and remembered badly.
Direct outreach	Personal messages referencing something specific about that person. Twenty a day, researched.	Templated mass sending. It converts near zero and damages your name.
Content	Write the guide your customer searches for at the moment the problem bites. Slow, compounding, durable.	Expecting results in month one. This channel pays from month four.
Launch platforms	A concentrated day of attention and useful early feedback.	Treating a launch as a strategy. It is a spike, not a channel.
Partnerships	Consultants and coaches who already serve your audience and can recommend or resell.	Approaching before you have proof it works for someone.
Integration listings	Appearing in the directory of a tool your customers already use.	Underrating it — this is one of the most reliable passive channels for small B2B tools.

How to be present in a community without being ejected

1. Join and read for a week. Learn how people talk and what has already been discussed to death.
2. Answer questions in your problem area, thoroughly, with no link and no mention of your product.

3. Do that for three to four weeks. You will become mildly known as the person who understands this.
4. When someone describes exactly your problem, message them privately and offer to show them what you built. Not a pitch — an offer to help.
5. Only after all that, if the rules permit, share the product publicly.

This is slower than it sounds and faster than every alternative.

> **THE OUTREACH MESSAGE THAT WORKS**
>
> One specific observation about them. One sentence on the problem in their language. One question, not a pitch. No link in the first message.
>
> *"Saw your post about spending Sunday evenings on client reports. I've been building something for exactly that and I'd rather show three people it's useless than launch to nobody — would you be up for a ten-minute look? Happy to just send a screenshot if easier."*

What to do with the first ten once you have them

Treat them as collaborators rather than customers. Reply to every message personally, within hours. Ask each one what nearly stopped them signing up. Ask what they would tell a colleague the product does — their answer is better marketing copy than anything you will write. Ship one requested improvement quickly and tell them it was their idea.

Ten delighted customers produce referrals, testimonials, case studies and the confidence to charge properly. A hundred indifferent signups produce nothing at all.

When to stop doing things by hand

Around customer twenty to thirty, patterns emerge: the same objection, the same first question, the same use case. That is your signal to build repeatable assets — a proper onboarding sequence, a help page, a comparison article, an integration listing. Not before. Systems built on guesses are systems you rebuild.

CHAPTER NINE

Nine Mistakes That Kill Micro SaaS

Almost every failure in this category is one of nine failures. Read this list once now, and again in month three when you will recognise yourself in it.

1. Building before validating

The dominant cause, by a wide margin. Weeks of work, then the discovery that nobody will pay. The cure costs four weeks and is in Chapter 5. There is no excuse for skipping it and almost everyone does.

2. Choosing an audience you cannot reach

A perfect product for hospital procurement managers is worthless if you have no route to a single one. Before committing, name the exact places you will find your first ten customers. If you cannot name three, the idea is not viable *for you*, whatever its merits.

3. Building for everyone

Broadening the audience feels like expanding the market and actually destroys your only advantage. A tool for “small businesses” competes with funded companies and speaks to nobody. A tool for independent physiotherapy clinics competes with a spreadsheet and speaks precisely.

4. Scope creep before launch

Every week of “just one more feature” is a week without customer feedback, and it is usually fear of launching wearing a productive disguise. Ship the three features. The fourth should be requested by someone paying.

5. Underpricing

Nine dollars a month attracts the highest-maintenance customers, produces almost no revenue per support hour, and signals that the product is not serious. Price against the value of the problem, not against your discomfort. See Chapter 7.

6. Treating launch as a distribution strategy

A launch day produces a spike and a handful of signups, then silence. Sustainable acquisition is months of showing up in communities, writing useful things and sending personal messages. Founders who plan only for launch day quit in week six when the graph flattens.

7. Ignoring churn while chasing signups

New signups are exciting and cancellations are quiet, so founders watch the wrong number for months. If people leave as fast as they arrive, more marketing simply fills a leaking bucket faster. Email every person who cancels and ask one question: what were you hoping this would do that it did not?

8. Building an AI wrapper with no workflow around it

A page that forwards a prompt to a model and returns the answer is not defensible, because anyone can build it in an afternoon and the model provider may ship it as a feature. The business is in the niche knowledge, the integrations, the formatting and the place it sits in someone's existing process. The model is a component, never the product.

9. Quitting at month three

The realistic curve is slow. A handful of customers by month two, perhaps ten by month four, and compounding after that if retention holds. Most founders quit somewhere between month three and month five, precisely where the content, the referrals and the search traffic were about to begin working.

> **THE ONE-SENTENCE SUMMARY OF THIS ENTIRE BOOK**
>
> Pick a customer you genuinely understand, confirm they will pay before you build anything, ship the smallest thing that solves one painful problem, charge properly for it from day one, and keep showing up for longer than feels reasonable.

Everything else — the tools, the stack, the thirty ideas — is detail in service of that sentence.

APPENDIX A

No-Code Tool Directory

Pricing moves constantly. Treat every figure below as an order-of-magnitude guide and confirm current plans on each vendor's own pricing page before committing.

App builders

Tool	Use it when	Rough entry cost
Softr	Client portals, B2B dashboards, per-customer data isolation on top of Airtable or Supabase	Free tier; paid from ~$49–$59/mo
Glide	Spreadsheet data into a clean app quickly; excellent for validating in hours	Free tier; paid from ~$19/mo
Bubble	Fully custom logic and your own data model; the most flexible option	Free to start; paid plus usage charges
Knack	Record- and form-heavy apps with role-based permissions	Paid tiers by records and users
Adalo / FlutterFlow	Genuine native mobile apps in the app stores	Free tiers; paid tiers vary
AI app builders	Describing a product in plain English and getting a working full-stack app	Typically $25–$79/mo

Data, automation and the rest of the stack

Layer	Options and notes
Database	**Airtable** — friendliest, pairs perfectly with Softr, has per-plan record limits. **Supabase** — more capable and cheaper at scale, generous free tier, slightly steeper. **Google Sheets** — fine for validation and prototypes, not for production.
Automation	**Make** — visual, powerful, good value; the default recommendation. **Zapier** — the widest integration library, more expensive per operation. **n8n** — most flexible and self-hostable, more technical.
Payments	**Stripe** — the standard for subscriptions. **Paddle** and **Lemon Squeezy** act as merchant of record and handle sales tax across jurisdictions, which is worth real money once you sell internationally.
Email	**Resend** or **Postmark** for transactional messages. **Brevo** or **Mailchimp** for marketing sequences. Keep the two separate — deliverability depends on it.

Marketing site	**Carrd** for a fast, very cheap landing page. **Framer** or **Webflow** when design matters. **WordPress** when a content engine is the strategy.
Analytics	A lightweight, privacy-friendly analytics tool is sufficient. Add a product analytics tool only once you have enough users for the numbers to mean anything.

APPENDIX B

The 30-Day Launch Checklist

Assumes you have completed the validation sprint in Chapter 5 and someone has already paid you something.

Days 1–7 — Foundations

- [ ] Write the one-sentence job on paper
- [ ] Sketch the three screens
- [ ] Design the data tables in a spreadsheet
- [ ] Choose and set up your builder
- [ ] Working signup and login
- [ ] Live Stripe subscription, tested with a real card
- [ ] Buy the domain and set up email

Days 8–14 — Core build

- [ ] Input screen complete
- [ ] Core automation or processing works end to end
- [ ] Output or results screen complete
- [ ] One full run works, however unpolished
- [ ] Two test accounts confirm data isolation

Days 15–21 — Make it survivable

- [ ] Error messages for every failure path
- [ ] Notification and confirmation emails
- [ ] Empty state with sample data or a prompt
- [ ] Mobile layout checked on a real phone
- [ ] Garbage-input testing done
- [ ] Cancel and re-subscribe flow verified

Days 22–30 — Launch

- [ ] Landing page updated with real screenshots
- [ ] Pricing page live with two plans
- [ ] Privacy policy and terms published
- [ ] Support email working and monitored
- [ ] Three-email onboarding sequence live
- [ ] Founding members invited personally
- [ ] Posted in two communities you belong to
- [ ] Twenty personal outreach messages sent
- [ ] Analytics installed and confirmed working

Ongoing — every week after

- [ ] Reply to every customer message within a day
- [ ] Ten new outreach conversations
- [ ] One useful public post or answer
- [ ] Record MRR, new customers and cancellations
- [ ] Ask one cancelling customer why
- [ ] Ship one improvement a customer requested

IF YOU SLIP

Thirty days is a target, not a contract. Slipping to sixty is normal for a first product built in evenings. Slipping to a hundred and eighty usually means scope crept — cut features, not the deadline.

APPENDIX C

Blank Idea Scorecard

Print or copy this page. Fill one in for each idea you are seriously considering, then compare the totals rather than your enthusiasm.

Field	Your answer
Idea number / name	
Exact customer (be specific)	
The problem, in their words	
What they do today instead	
Target price per month	
Three places I will find the first ten	
My unfair advantage here	

The five-question filter

Question	Green	Red
1. Do I genuinely understand this customer?		
2. Can I find ten of them to talk to this week?		
3. Can I build a first version in two weekends?		
4. Would I pay the target price for this myself?		
5. Does a paying market already exist?		
Total green lights		

4–5 green: start the validation sprint. **3 green:** proceed, but validate hard. **0–2 green:** choose another idea.

Validation sprint tracker

Week	Target	Actual

1 — Interviews	10–15 conversations completed
2 — Landing page	100 visitors, 20+ signups
3 — Pre-sale	At least 1 person pays
4 — Decision	Build / iterate / kill

APPENDIX D

Where to Keep Learning

Communities worth your time

- **Indie Hackers** — founder revenue reports, honest post-mortems, active discussion of exactly this business model.
- **MicroConf** — the bootstrapped SaaS conference and its surrounding material; the five-question filter in Chapter 4 comes from this tradition.
- **r/microsaas, r/SaaS and r/nocode** — useful for demand signals and for watching real people describe real problems in their own words.
- **Your customers' communities** — more valuable than any of the above. The Facebook group where salon owners complain is worth more to you than any founder forum.

How to find ideas after this book

The thirty cards here are a starting point, not a limit. The most reliable sources of new ideas are all the same shape: people complaining specifically.

- **Your own job.** The spreadsheet you rebuilt three times. The report that takes a day every month. The workaround your team accepted years ago. This is the single richest source, and it is already yours.
- **One-star reviews of existing tools.** People telling you precisely what a product fails to do, at the moment they are angry enough to write it down.
- **Niche community threads** that begin “does anyone know a tool that…” and end with fourteen replies saying no.
- **Job listings** for repetitive coordination roles. A company hiring someone to compile reports manually is describing a product.
- **Consultants' onboarding documents.** Whatever they do for every client, every time, is a workflow that can be productised.

LAST WORD

The hard part was never the code — and now, for you, the code has been removed entirely. What remains is judgement: choosing a customer, listening carefully, and building the small unglamorous thing they will pay for every month.

That work cannot be outsourced to a tool. It is also the part that is genuinely worth learning, because it transfers to every business you will ever build.

Now go and pick one idea.